

MARKING SCHEME

CAT 1 TERM 1

SOFTWARE INSTALLATION & USER ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT

MARKING SCHEME

Total Marks: 50

Question 1 (6 Marks)

Distinguish between System Software and Application Software, giving two examples of each.

Answer	Marks
System Software: Software that manages computer hardware and provides a platform for application software.	1
Two examples (Windows, Linux, macOS, Android, etc.)	2
Application Software: Software designed to perform specific user tasks.	1
Two examples (MS Word, Excel, Chrome, Photoshop, VLC, etc.)	2

Total: 6 Marks

Question 2 (4 Marks)

Methods of Collecting Software User Needs

Award 1 mark each (Any Four)

1. Interviews
2. Questionnaires/Surveys
3. Observation
4. Focus Group Discussions
5. Workshops
6. Document Analysis
7. Brainstorming Sessions
8. Prototyping

Total: 4 Marks

Question 3 (4 Marks)

Factors to Consider Before Purchasing Software

Award **1 mark each** (Any Four)

1. Cost of acquisition
2. Licensing requirements
3. Security features
4. Vendor support and maintenance
5. Ease of use
6. Scalability
7. Reliability
8. Integration with existing systems
9. Training requirements
10. Legal and regulatory compliance

Total: 4 Marks

Question 4 (4 Marks)

Advantages and Disadvantages of Off-the-Shelf Software

Advantages (1 mark each)

1. Lower purchase cost
2. Readily available
3. Tested and reliable
4. Vendor support available

Disadvantages (1 mark each)

1. Limited customization
2. May contain unnecessary features
3. Licensing restrictions
4. Dependence on vendor updates

Award any 2 advantages and any 2 disadvantages

Total: 4 Marks

Question 5 (4 Marks)

User Account Settings/Parameters

Award **1 mark each** (Any Four)

1. Password length
2. Password complexity
3. Password expiry period
4. Account lockout threshold
5. User permissions
6. Profile picture
7. Login hours
8. Group membership
9. Home directory settings
10. Account expiration date

Total: 4 Marks

Question 6 (6 Marks)

Differences Between Account Types

Administrator Account (2 Marks)

- Full control over the system. (1)
- Can install software, modify settings, and manage users. (1)

Standard User Account (2 Marks)

- Limited privileges. (1)
- Can run applications but cannot make major system changes without authorization. (1)

Guest Account (2 Marks)

- Very limited access. (1)
- Intended for temporary users and cannot permanently modify system settings. (1)

Total: 6 Marks

Question 7 (12 Marks)

a) Software Selection Process (8 Marks)

Award **1 mark each** for any valid step.

1. Identify business problems and objectives.
2. Gather user requirements from accountants.
3. Document functional and non-functional requirements.
4. Research available accounting software.
5. Compare features and costs.
6. Request demonstrations or trial versions.
7. Evaluate software against requirements.
8. Select the most suitable software.
9. Obtain management approval.
10. Purchase and deploy the software.

Maximum: 8 Marks

b) Software Acquisition Methods (4 Marks)

Method 1: Off-the-Shelf Purchase (1 Mark)

Commercially available software purchased from a vendor.

Method 2: Bespoke/Custom Development (1 Mark)

Software specifically developed to meet organizational requirements.

Appropriate Scenario (2 Marks)

- Off-the-shelf preferred when requirements are common and implementation is needed quickly.
- Bespoke preferred when the organization has unique business processes requiring specialized features.

Total: 4 Marks

Question 8 (10 Marks)

a) Appropriate User Accounts (6 Marks)

Senior IT Administrator (2 Marks)

Administrator Account

Reason:

- Requires full system access for maintenance, configuration, and troubleshooting.

Permanent Receptionist (2 Marks)

Standard User Account

Reason:

- Can perform daily duties while preventing unauthorized system changes.

Visiting Clients/Interns (2 Marks)

Guest Account

Reason:

- Temporary access with restricted privileges for security.

Total: 6 Marks

b) Security Risks of Using a Shared Account (4 Marks)

Award **1 mark each** (Any Four)

1. Lack of accountability/audit trail.
2. Unauthorized access to sensitive files.
3. Increased risk of malware infection.
4. Accidental deletion or modification of data.
5. Password sharing vulnerabilities.
6. Difficulty tracking user activities.
7. Potential privilege misuse.
8. Increased insider security threats.

Total: 4 Marks